2001 ESCAPE STEERING WHEEL RETENTION NUT

AFFECTED VEHICLES: CERTAIN 2001 MODEL YEAR ESCAPE

OVERVIEW

All vehicles will require installation of a ***new*** steering wheel armature. Also, vehicles with incorrectly assembled armatures will require installation of a ***new*** steering column assembly in addition to a ***new*** armature. This procedure will instruct you on how to identify a correctly assembled armature. The nut that retains the steering wheel to the steering shaft may have been installed backwards in the armature. This nut is tapered on one side to mate with the tapered shoulder of the steering column shaft. The other side of the nut has a square edge. The armature must be removed from the steering wheel to properly examine the retention nut in the armature. The steering wheel access cover has a torque information label attached to it. This label contains inaccurate information; therefore, it must be removed and discarded. The correct torque for the steering wheel retention nut is 12 Nm (9 lb-ft).

SERVICE PROCEDURE

CAUTION: Disconnect the horn/speed control electrical connector from the clockspring before removing the steering wheel. Failure to do so will result in damage to the clockspring or steering wheel.

1. Remove the steering wheel. Follow the Workshop Manual (Section 211-04) procedure for steering wheel removal with the exception of: Disconnect the horn/speed control electrical connector before you loosen the steering wheel retaining nut pinion shaft. See Figure 1.

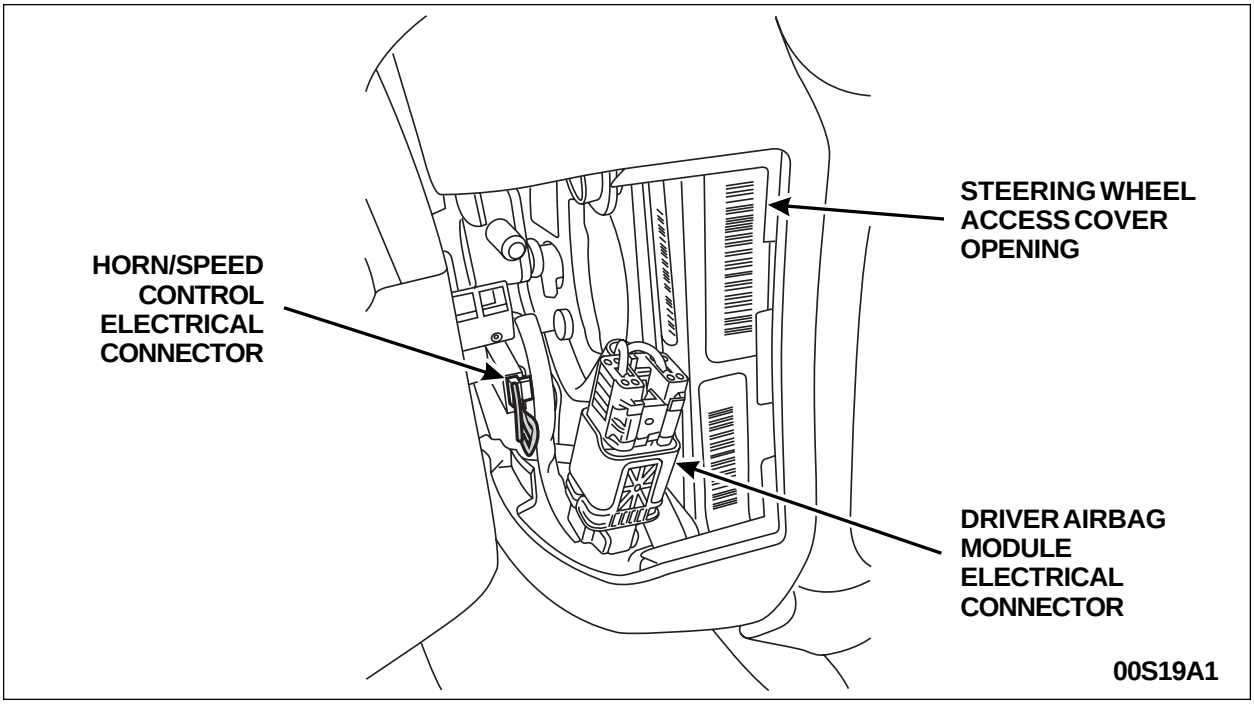
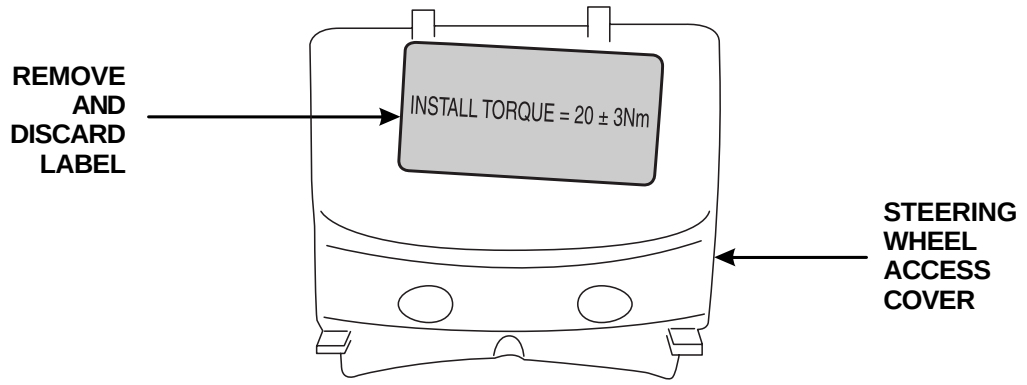


FIGURE 1

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2. **CAUTION: The torque information label located on the steering wheel access cover contains inaccurate information. This label MUST be removed and discarded.**

   Remove and discard the torque information label. See Figure 2.



LABEL CONTAINS INACCURATE INFORMATION

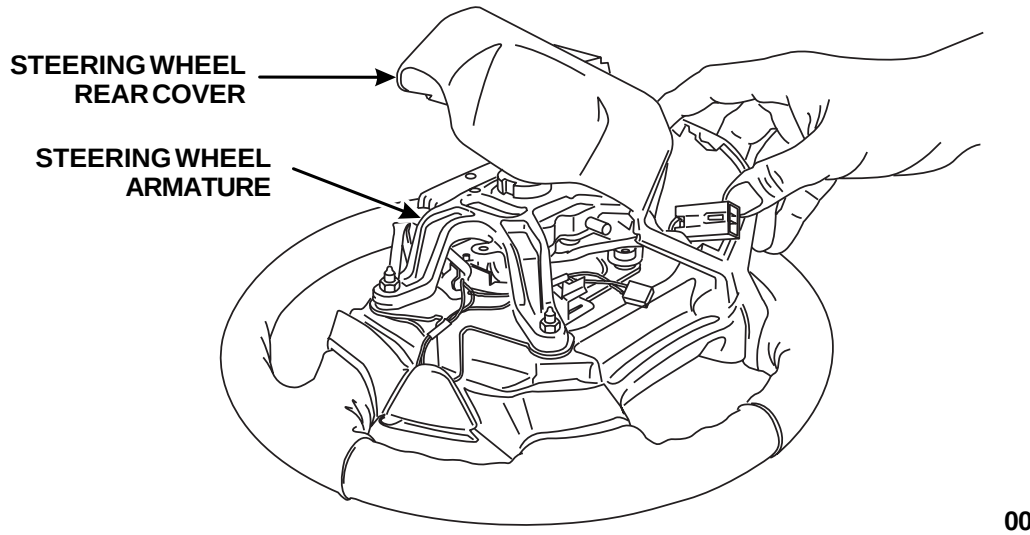
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FIGURE 2

3. **CAUTION: Place the steering wheel on a clean protected surface during disassembly.**

   Disassemble the steering wheel as follows. See Figure 3.

   - Remove the steering wheel rear cover.
   - Remove the steering wheel armature.



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FIGURE 3

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4. View the steering wheel armature from the front face (steering wheel retention nut plate should be visible) as shown in the illustration. See Figure 4.

5. **CAUTION: Do not reinstall the original armature after inspection. Install a *new* armature on all vehicles.**

   NOTE: The steering wheel retention nut is directly below the steering wheel retention nut plate.

   Inspect the steering wheel retention nut. The surface of the steering wheel retention nut should form a square edge with the threads of the nut. See Figure 4.

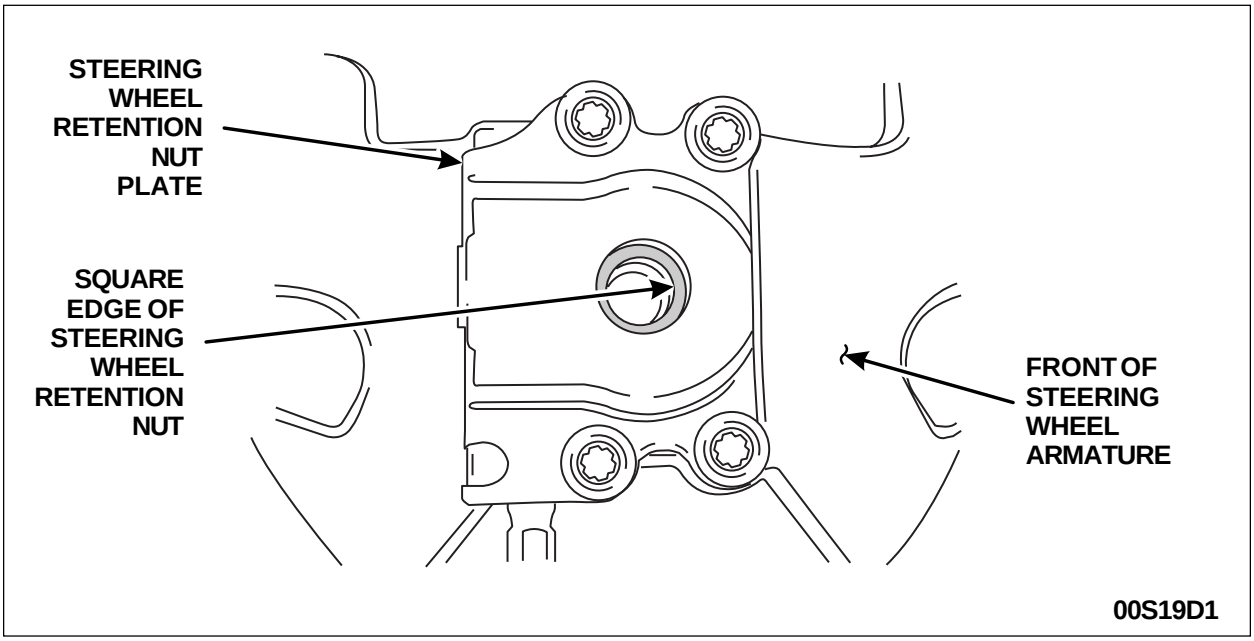


FIGURE 4

A. If a square edge is found, the steering wheel retention nut is correctly installed.
   - Install a ***new*** steering wheel armature. Tighten the nuts to 12 Nm (9 lb-ft).
   - Install the steering wheel rear cover. Tighten the screws to 2 Nm (18 lb-in).
   - Install the steering wheel. Tighten the steering wheel retention nut to 12 Nm (9 lb-ft). Refer to the service procedures in Section 211-04 of the appropriate Workshop Manual.

B. If a tapered edge is found, the steering wheel retention nut is NOT correctly installed. The steering wheel armature AND steering column must be replaced.
   - Install a ***new*** steering column (Refer to your parts catalog to determine the specific steering column [-3524-] for the vehicle application). Use two (2) ***new*** ignition module shear bolts (YL8Z-12049-AA) and one (1) ***new*** pinch bolt (YL8Z-3R827-AA) when installing the ***new*** steering column. Refer to the service procedures in Section 211-04 of the appropriate Workshop Manual.
   - Install a ***new*** steering wheel armature. Tighten the nuts to 12 Nm (9 lb-ft).
   - Install the steering wheel rear cover. Tighten the screws to 2 Nm (18 lb-in).
   - Install the steering wheel. Tighten the steering wheel retention nut to 12 Nm (9 lb-ft). Refer to the service procedures in Section 211-04 of the appropriate Workshop Manual.

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